

2 Mobile phone Features

Wi-Fi: A lot of new mid-end and high-end phones have this feature. Here connection speed bottleneck is only the internet connectivity of your Wi-Fi connection. On home broadband networks, you can expect to comfortably work with even streaming YouTube videos. It is important to decide if you really need this feature. If your office or home has Wi-Fi network or you spend a lot of time at the airport, it is a must have feature.

2.3 Location awareness

Cell-phone tower triangulation

The feature came to prominence first with the initial generations of iPhone (before the incorporation of GPS), here by using the data available from three nearest cell sites. It approximates your position on the globe. This is the fastest location awareness method, but is also the least accurate. It is technically present in all phones. You just need to have the right application with the right access to phone features to use it.

GPS: If you are in a travelling job and often find yourself in a new city with no idea of directions and a language barrier, buying a phone equipped with GPS and a navigation software can be a worth idea. With the current software versions that have road level navigation and voice support, you can get detailed driving instructions on your phone. A GPS equipped phone with a 2.5-inch screen can work nearly as well as a dedicated GPS unit.

GPS is the most accurate location aware method available on a phone today or any mobile device.

However, be aware that getting an initial satellite-lock can take up to 20 seconds outdoors and more than a minute in a moving car. GPS doesn't work indoors.

A-GPS: This stands for assisted-GPS. Basically, your phone first contacts the nearest network tower and then asks for its current location to narrow down the search. It decreases the time it takes to get a satellite lock.

For those looking for a method where you can navigate without using GPRS/EDGE for loading of maps, try using a Java application called "We-Travel". It has offline maps that can be locally stored in your phone for faster access and no data charges. It has a map package for India too.



A mobile phone, showing WiFi connectivity options



A side by side comparison of dedicated unit vs a mobile phone. With a bigger screens, difference is hardly noticeable